

Interview Guide

Goal:

- Understand the larger context of users' work, into which your product must fit
- Get a deeper understanding of user motivations, needs, desired outcomes, obstacles, and behaviors
- Discover opportunities to delight users and inspire loyalty

Participants: PLEXOS/Aurora User - Data Modelers, Managers

Format: Remote, Zoom call, approx. 45 mins

Intro

- Who we are, length of time, any questions?
- Recording: used not outside UX, transcribed, anonymous quotes might be in report
- Permission to record?
- *Thank you for agreeing to speak with us. We are currently working on next generation concepts for PLEXOS/Aurora and power modelling. Part of this project is understanding how PLEXOS is currently being used and what the modelling experience is like for our users.*
- *So today we will start with some basic questions to find out about the type of modelling you do and then we'll move into questions about your experience using PLEXOS/Aurora*
- *Part of an ongoing program called 'goal-directed design', we want to make our users part of the design process with ongoing dialog and design reviews to validation our product design direction.*

Background

- Company name, organization, industry, team
- What is your job title and how long have you been in the role?
- Experience: Length of tenure (company and industry overall)
- Why? What do you like about your job?

Tell me more about the team you work in and the office setup

- Your responsibilities and team responsibilities
- Organization, management
- How many colleagues, on-site or remote?
- How do you collaborate with your team?
- What is your Workstation setup?

What types of projects do you work on? What types of modelling do you do?

- What are you currently working on?

How long have you been a PLEXOS/Aurora user?

- How did you learn about PLEXOS/Aurora?
- How much time do you spend on PLEXOS/Aurora in a given day?
- What has been your experience working with Energy Exemplar?

Tell me about a typical day at the office

What's a typical project you are working on?

- Stakeholder: Who assigns your projects? Who is the internal "customer"?
- One study at a time? Multitasking? Other projects and responsibilities?
- How does PLEXOS/Aurora fit into your daily workflow?
 - Which projects do you use PLEXOS/Aurora? Other tools used for other projects?
- How long does a typical PLEXOS/Aurora project last? Typical time frame for a typical study.
- What kind of deliverables are there?
 - Who relies on this information?
 - How do you view the results of a simulation?
 - How do you publish reports? [PDF reports, easier to share, other tools?]
 - What happens next?
- What are the first steps you take when starting a new project?
- How do you use Search and Filters?
 - What works well, what not? Suggestions for improvements?
- Collaboration:
 - With whom? What type of collaboration?
 - Real time, Chat, email, phone?

What are you most worried about?

- When project is assigned, and during the work process

Other tools in the toolbox, software tools you use most?

- Technical proficiency: are they a programmer?
- Working with Excel
- Working with SQL Server

What do you like/dislike about working with PLEXOS/Aurora?

If you had a magic wand....

- What is the one thing you would like to see in the next gen PLEXOS/Aurora product?